

VIDEO SPLITTING AND JOINING TOOLS

As you've gathered, freeware for anything and everything is available. In the area of video splitting and joining tools, however, we are unhappy to say, we haven't found anything to our expectations. As we wait for that killer free video splitting and joining freeware, here's a collection of what's currently available.

VidSplitter

www.geovid.com/VidSplitter/

This application splits a single video file into multiple pre-defined or user-definable sizes. On the plus side you have a range of output codecs (both audio and video) to select from, so you can also—to some extent—convert your video file on the fly rather than having to prepare it beforehand. However, this falls short of the splitting and joining functions we have in mind. VidSplitter is primarily a tool to split video files into manageable chunks for CD or e-mail distribution, where each file can be viewed independently without needing to be rejoined.

AviSplit Classic 1.43

www.bobyte.com

For quick and dirty cutting and joining of .avi files, AviSplit should do the trick. The interface is clean and there are three tabs—to split, rejoin and clip. Like VidSplitter, Split will break up the source AVI file into optimally-sized chunks that can be played independently. Again, fit for e-mailing or CD distribution. “Rejoin” merges those chunks in the specified sequence. One interesting feature with Rejoin is that you can exclude any parts you don't want, and AviSplit will automatically jump to the next part in the sequence and merge from there forward. “Clip” is used to extract a specific segment by giving the start and stop time within the segment. Though you cannot join a clipped segment to another split, AviSplit does basic splitting and joining, though some more flexibility in joining clips to unrelated splits would have been good. That apart, the only reason we ruled it out as an acceptable candidate is that, as the name suggests, you can only work with AVI files.